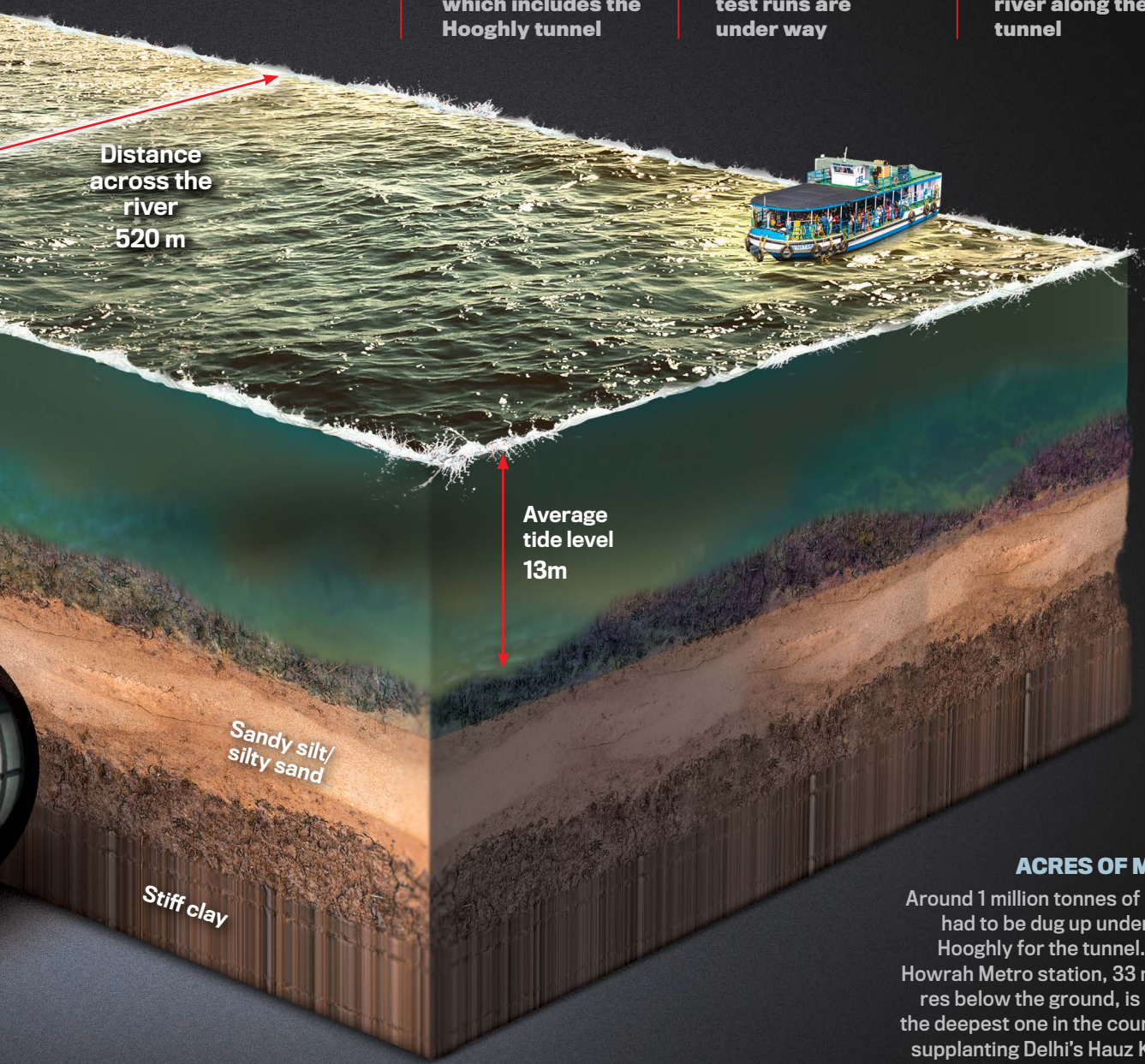
Below the Hooghly

520 m
Length of the tunnel under the Hooghly river

4.8 km
Length of the stretch between Howrah Maidan and Esplanade, which includes the Hooghly tunnel

45 sec
Time taken to cover the section under the Hooghly river. Extensive test runs are under way

80 kmph
Speed at which a train will run under the Hooghly river along the tunnel



ACRES OF MUD

Around 1 million tonnes of mud had to be dug up under the Hooghly for the tunnel. The Howrah Metro station, 33 metres below the ground, is now the deepest one in the country, supplanting Delhi's Hauz Khas

BUILT TO LAST

For the tunnel below the river, waterproofing and the design of gaskets—meant to prevent any leakage of oil or steam between pipes—were major challenges. The tunnel has been constructed to last over 100 years

SLOW PROGRESS

The East-West Corridor was approved in 2009 and slated to be completed in 2012. But the project faced many delays, including when many houses in Bowbazar developed cracks. On April 20, a test run from Howrah Maidan and Esplanade stations was done. Trials will last months before full operations

SAFETY FIRST

Two 760-metre emergency shafts have been installed under the tunnel for evacuation as per National Fire Protection norms Association (NFPA) guidelines

Source: Kolkata Metro; PTI